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Material Encounters with digital Cultural Heritage

Parallel Exhibits: Combining Physical and Virtual Exhibits

Lars Lischke, Tilman Dingler, Stefan Schneegass,
Merel van der Vaart, Paweł Woźniak, Albrecht Schmidt

University of Stuttgart
Germany

University of Amsterdam
Allard Pierson Museum

CHALMERS

Introduction

- Physical objects with visible history
- Large number of exhibits
- Only a small number of objects can be on display



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Introduction

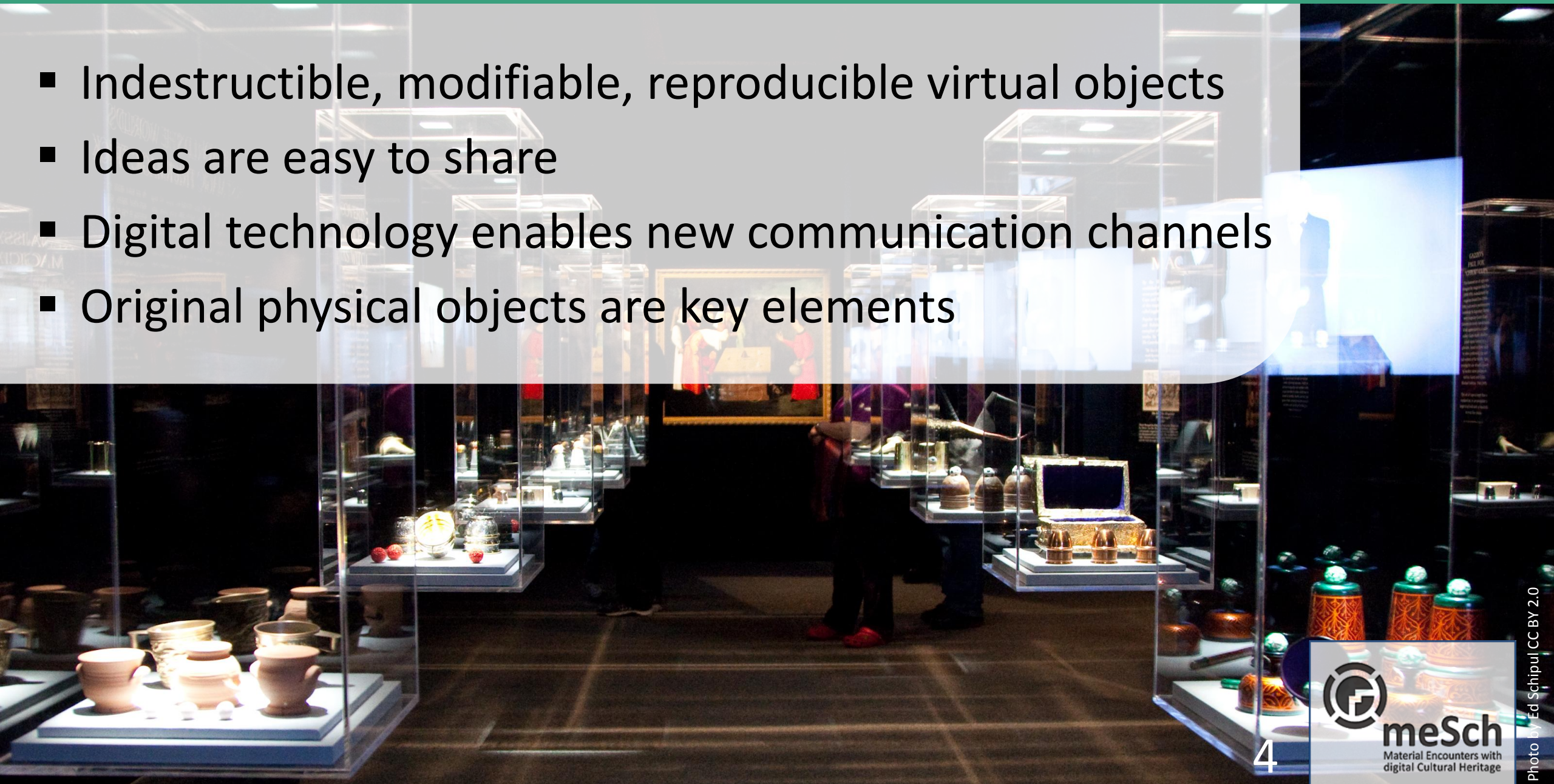
- Digital technology is changing the world
- Surfaces are getting more and more interactive
- Large object data bases



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Combining Physical and Virtual World

- Indestructible, modifiable, reproducible virtual objects
- Ideas are easy to share
- Digital technology enables new communication channels
- Original physical objects are key elements



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Engaging Visitors

- Digital technology create new ways for information and knowledge exchange
- More communication between visitors, curators, …



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Engaging Visitors

- Collaboration, participation, and co-curation
- Wallace Collection (London): Children develop storylines (Bryant 2011)
- The Museum of National History (Netherlands): invited the public to provide pictures of an online exhibition



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Parallel Exhibits

Connect virtual archives with the physical museums visit

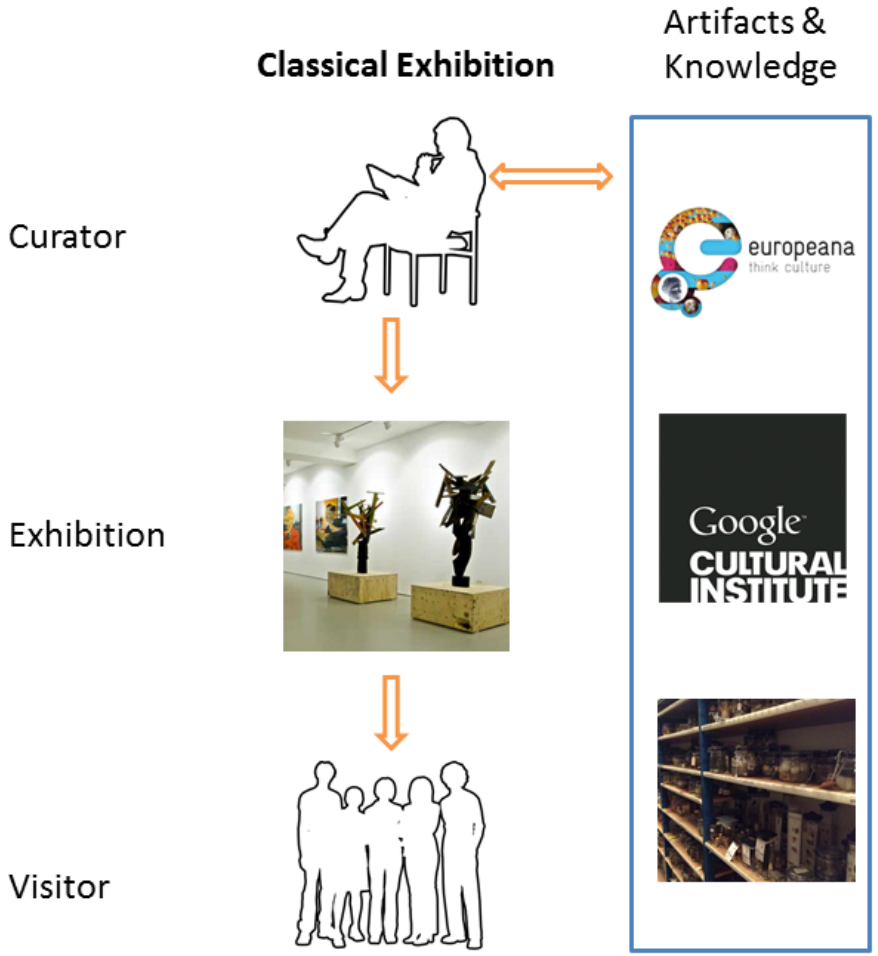
Artifacts &
Knowledge



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Parallel Exhibits

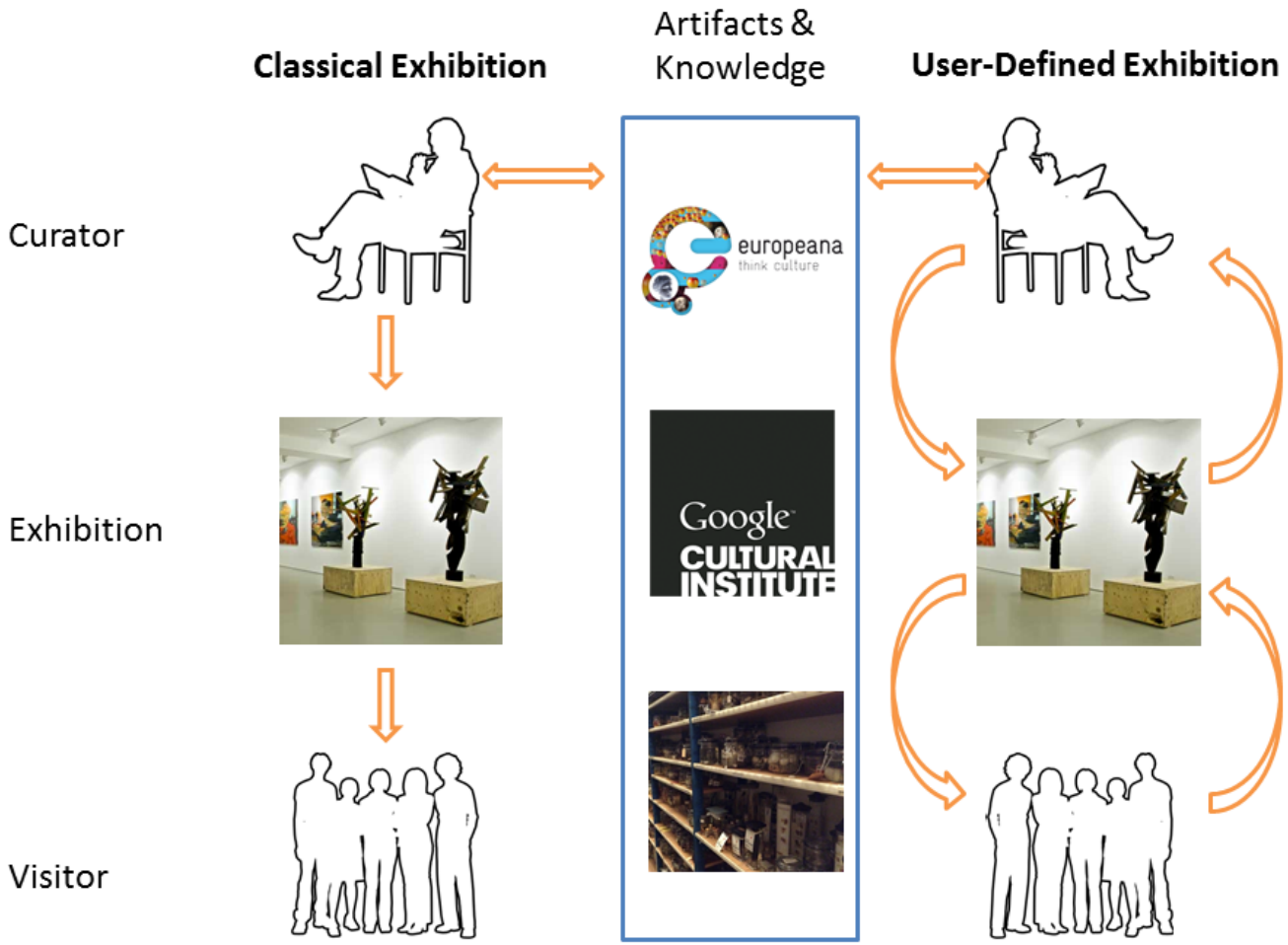
Connect virtual archives with the physical museums visit



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Parallel Exhibits

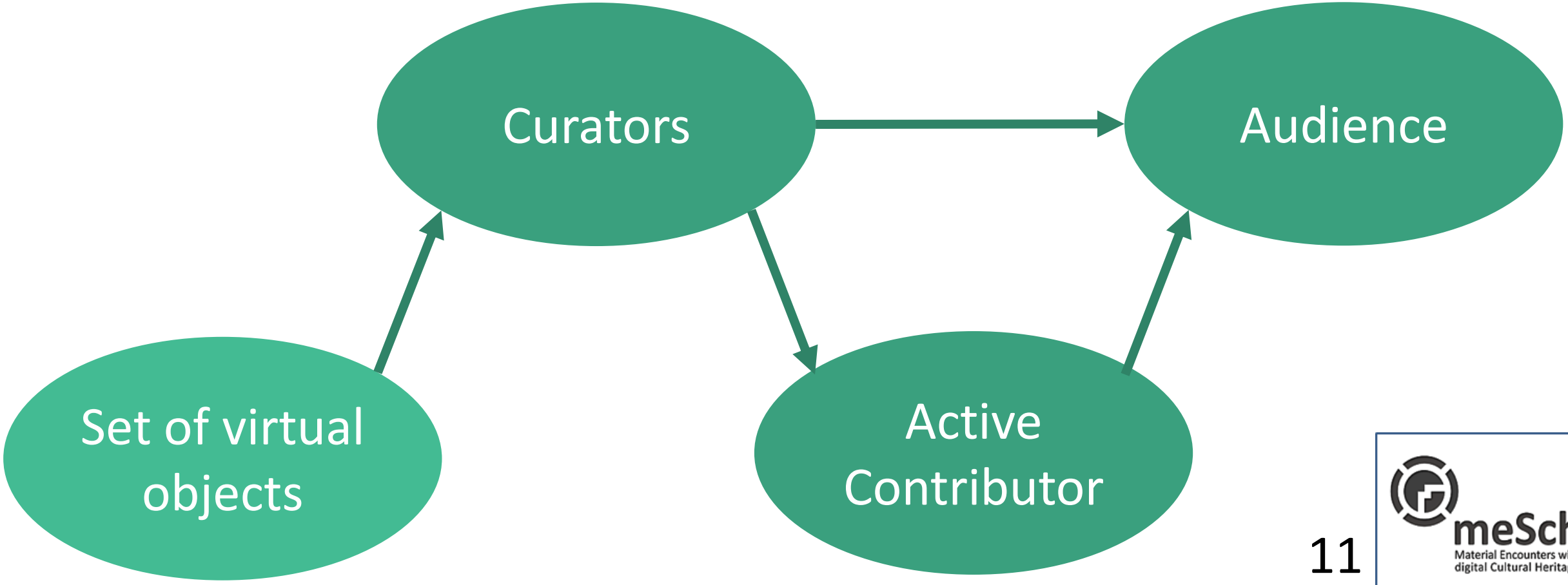
Connect virtual archives with the physical museums visit



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Parallel Exhibits

- Technology mediated design process
- Web-technology implementation



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Parallel Exhibits

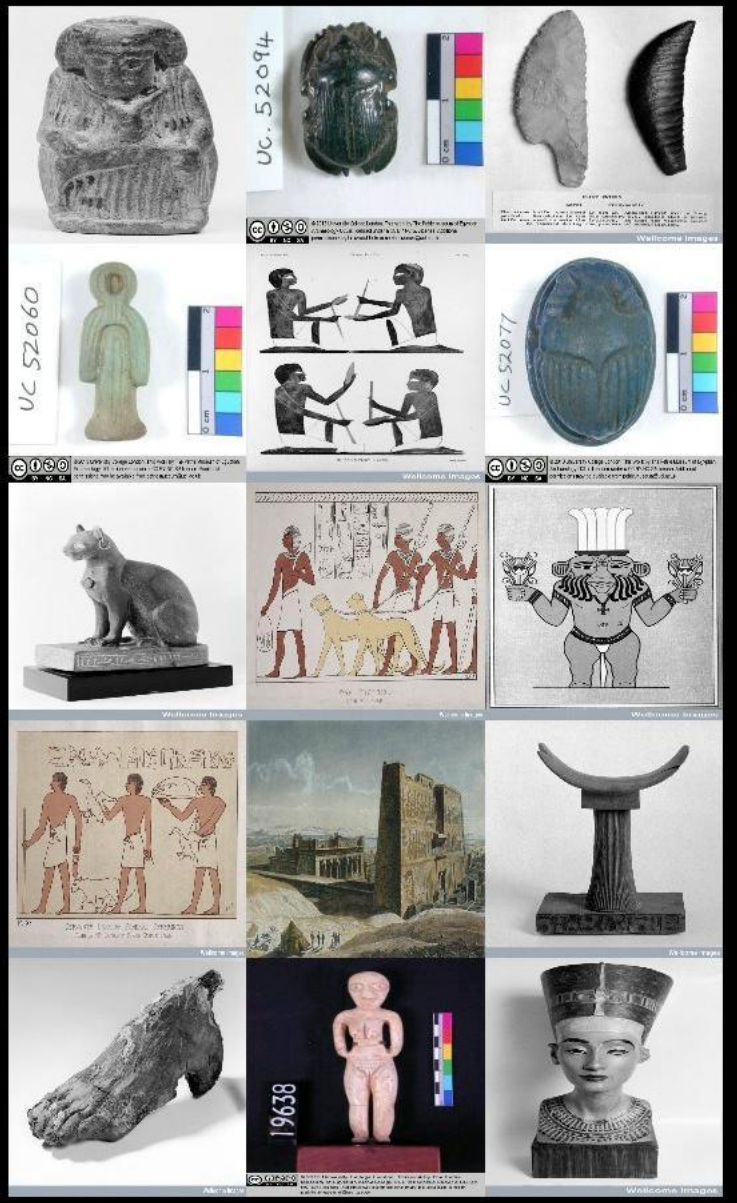
My favorites



Nice guys







Evaluation

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Field test

- Field test at the Allard Pierson Museum
- 35 Users during five hours

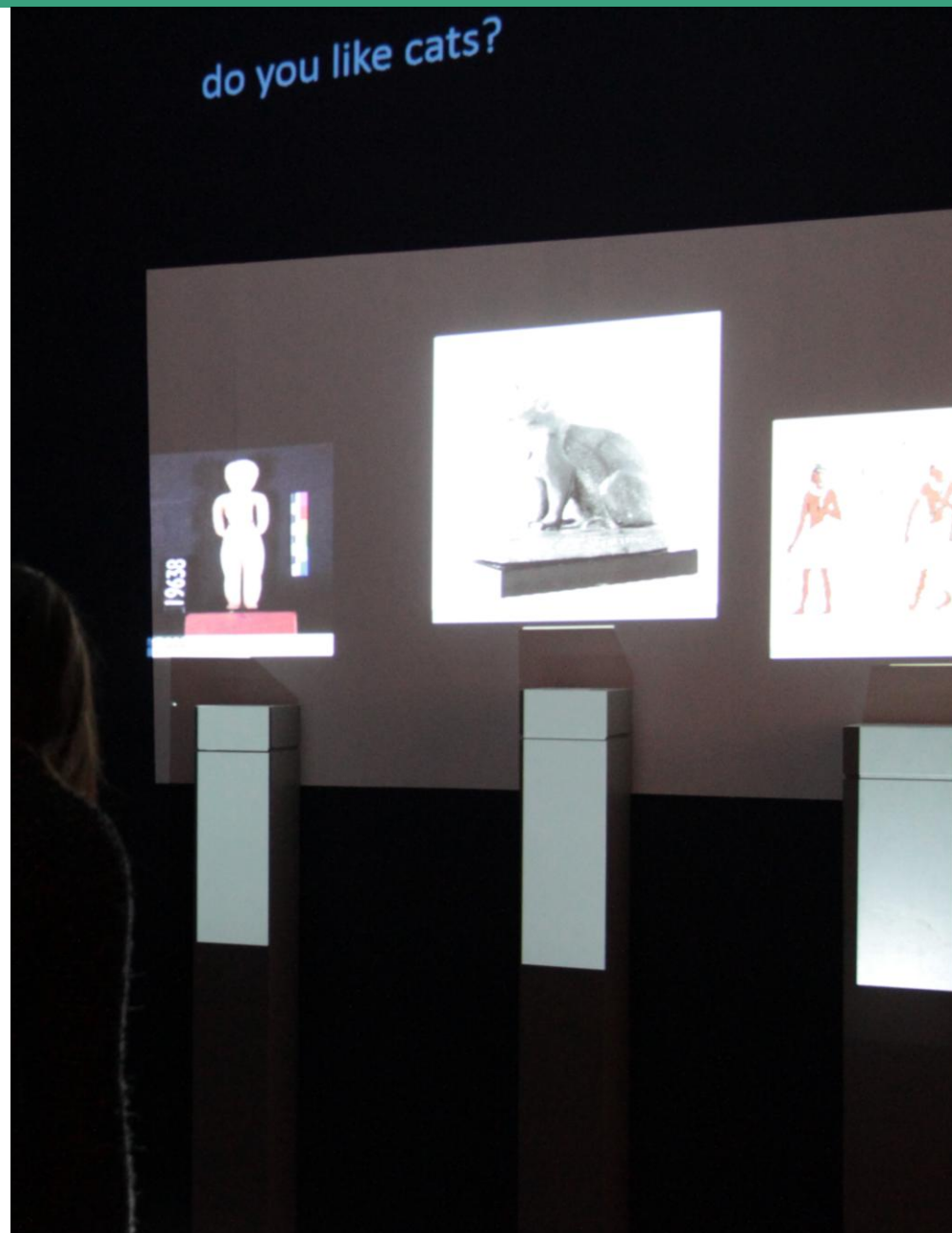
- Free exploration of the installation
- Pairs or smaller groups
- Discussions around the system



Field test

Findings:

- Interest in background information
- Game-elements
- Sharing arrangements
- Guiding-Approach



Online survey

- Getting more structured feedback
- Collecting quantitative data
- Testing an other use case

40
Participants

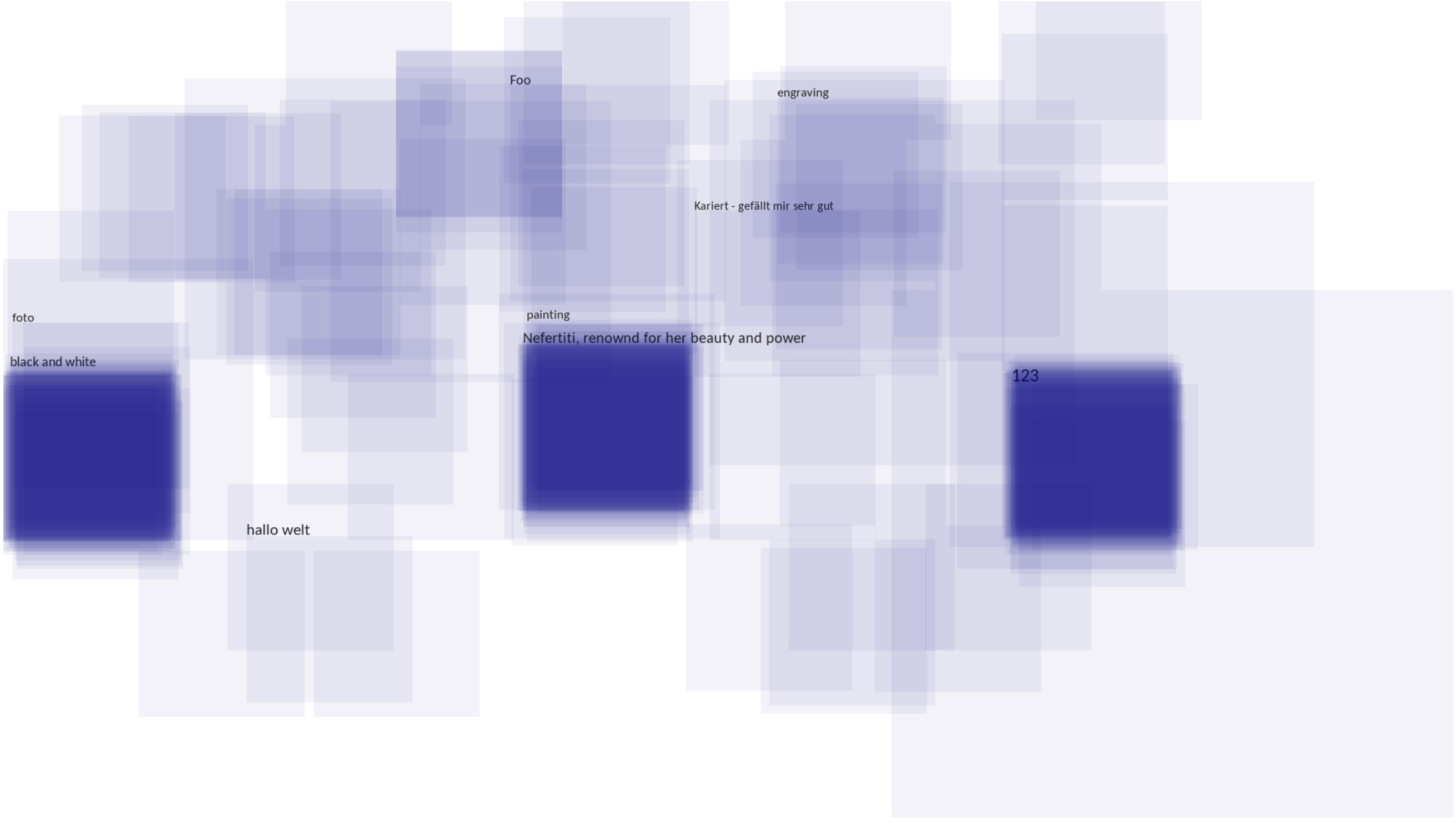
226
Seconds

6
Exhibits

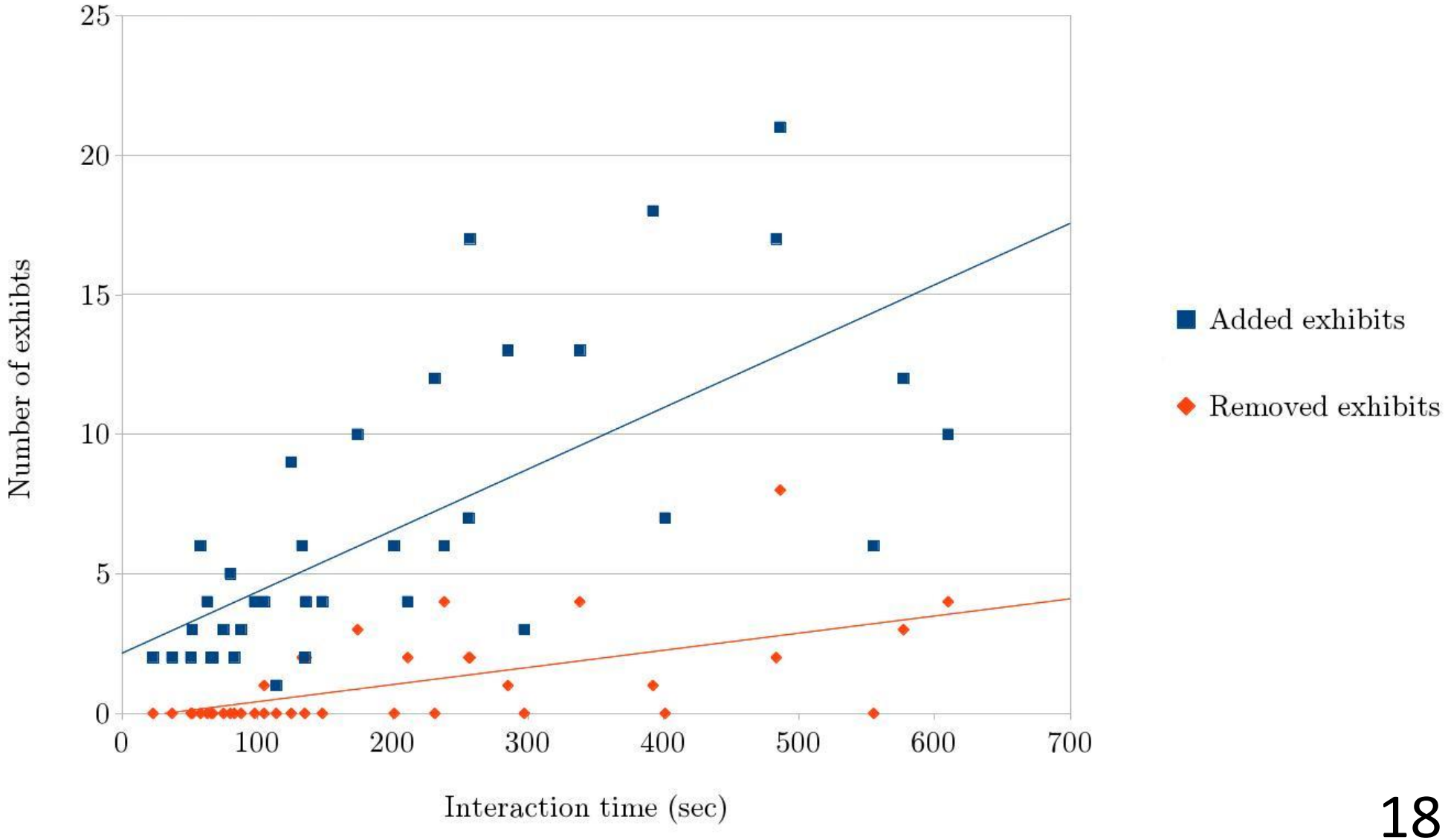
23
Actions

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Online survey



Online survey



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Online survey

Sharing ideas?

25%
On the museum's homepage

30%
Not at all

30%
On Facebook

45%
As a post card

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Online survey

Providing ideas?

20%
Sharing ideas

40%
Just for fun

55%
Something is missing

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Interviews with Curators

Interest in combining virtual and physical objects

Visitors are interested in contributing to exhibitions

How to guarantee quality

Other Scenario

Providing community-access from out side

Prototyping

Educational use

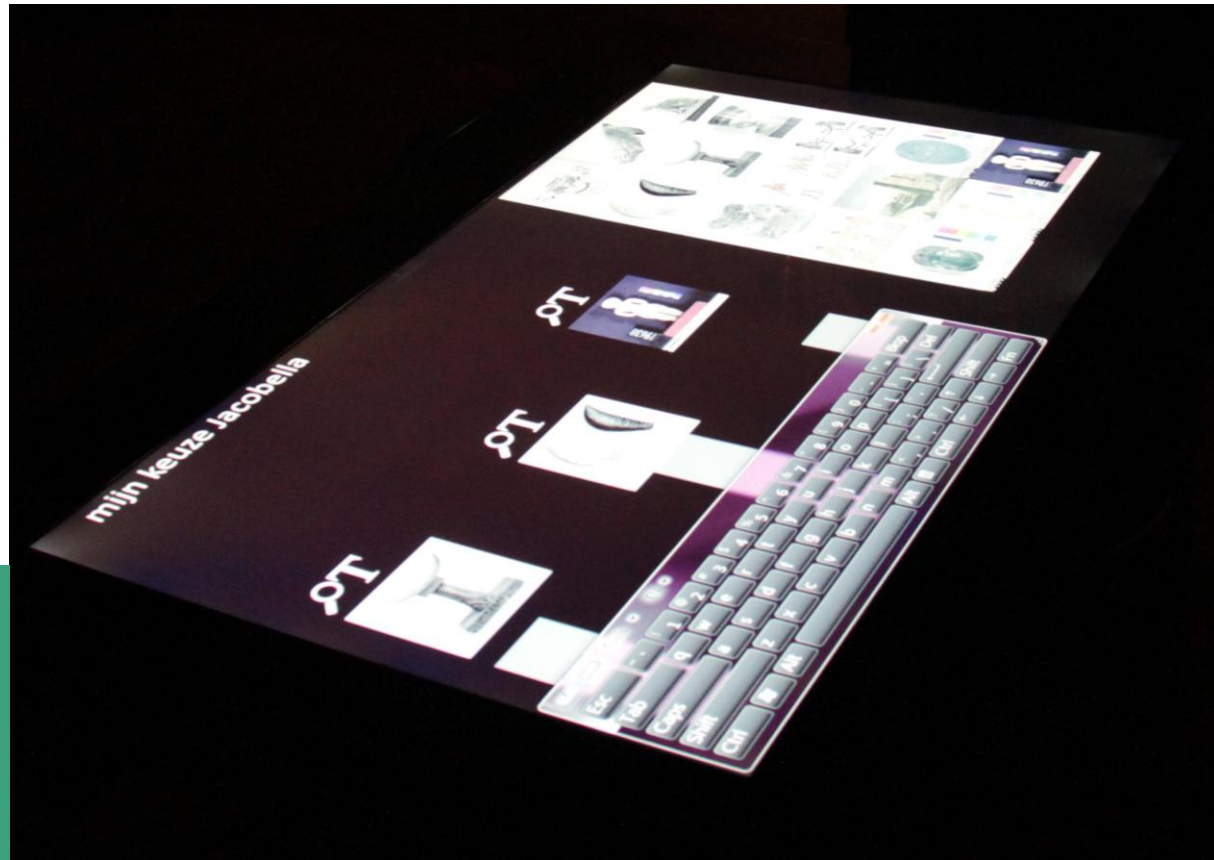
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Conclusion

- Parallel Exhibits allows visitors to take part in the curation process

- Parallel Exhibits creates a feedback loop between curator and visitor

- Virtual objects enrich physical exhibitions



Lars.Lischke@vis.uni-Stuttgart.de

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SEVENTH FRAMEWORK PROGRAMME